

TAKE ADVANTAGE OF PLANNED PARENTHOOD OR A FREE CLINIC IN YOUR AREA

If you are lucky enough to live in an area where you have access to Planned Parenthood or a similar clinic, it can be a godsend for people without health insurance. They most likely offer sliding scale services.

Of course, going on birth control (the main reason I visited PP) can be pricey. My pill, Ortho-tri Cyclen Lo, cost me \$110 a pack without insurance. With insurance, it was only around \$15. While I was without insurance, I went a full year without birth control pills. This meant a year of feeling *just lovely* once a month, because I didn't have a spare \$110 for the pills. The only health care shortcut I tried was going on a more generic, less expensive pill, but my uterus is a fickle beast and wanted only that sweet, sweet OTC-Lo. If yours is more resilient, give another lower-cost pill a try. (Also look into the PP Pink Card, which gives you free services and significant discounts.)

THE PRICE OF BABY MAKING

This book isn't going to break the news that having a baby is expensive. But even the expensive stuff can be surprisingly *expensive*.

This may come as a shock to long-time fans of my "wild girl" brand, but I want to have a kid someday. I love babies. I beeline to any baby in the room, and I don't mean to brag, but babies love me back. (Allison's toddler niece, Bella, told her mom that I'm also her aunt. Best compliment ever.) I like the idea of teaching a little human about the world. I also know that in the next five to seven years, before I'm considered by some to be a geriatric pregnancy (GROAN), I might not be able to afford it.

Still, if being able to afford a baby was a prerequisite for having one, many of us wouldn't be here, myself included. Since my partner and I are both cisgender women, we will probably have a journey toward having a child that includes either adoption or IVF. (All options are expensive, but we'll get to that later.)

The semi-anonymous millennial authors of the blog *Bitches Get Riches*, who go by the nicknames Piggy and Kitty, told me they've both decided to remain child free to consciously ease their lifetime financial woes. They don't want to